

HOUSE BILL 953

By Brooks

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49,
relative to the School Safety and Mental Health
Act.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. This act is known and may be cited as the "School Safety and Mental Health Act."

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49, Chapter 2, Part 1, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

Each LEA and public charter school shall employ at least one (1) full-time licensed professional school counselor for each school in the LEA or public charter school.

SECTION 3. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-6-4302, is amended by adding the following as a new subsection:

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(1) The Tennessee school safety center shall administer a school safety infrastructure grant program. The center shall develop a school safety infrastructure grant application that requires LEAs to describe, at a minimum, how grant funds:

(A) Will be used to improve and support school safety infrastructure;

(B) Align with the needs identified in a school security assessment conducted pursuant to subsection (f); and

(C) Will be used to support LEA-authorized charter schools, if applicable.

(2) In order to be eligible to receive grant funds, the LEA must be in compliance with all state laws, rules, and regulations regarding school safety.

(3) Subject to appropriations, the Tennessee school safety center shall award grants to LEAs that meet the requirements of this subsection (). Any funds appropriated for this program in any fiscal year that are not expended must be carried forward for program purposes in future fiscal years.

SECTION 4. This act takes effect July 1, 2025, the public welfare requiring it.